

DO YOU REALLY NEED THAT ACCESSORY?

We all love our gadgets and like to dress them in a variety of accessories, some useful, others not so much. Here we argue about their efficacy

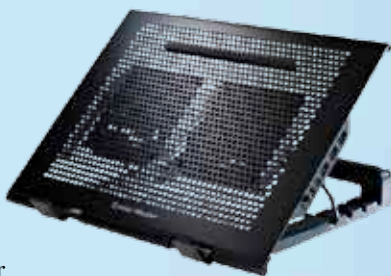
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We have a lot of distractions in this materialistic world, us tech-nophiles. Every new gadget we buy demands our attention to optimise, customise, tinker and tweak our experience with it. Sometimes, the urge isn't as much to do something more with our existing gadgets, as it is to give them a much-needed facelift, however expensive or ridiculous be the outcome. All of us are guilty of having been there and done that.

Within these two pages, we present a few accessories and validate their usefulness in our technology-filled lives. Maybe you'll agree, maybe you won't but the idea is to stop and check if you really need (and not merely want) that accessory for your gadget.

Laptop coolers Mostly effective

As people are gradually buying more laptops than desktops compared to a couple of years back – proven by a number of IDC and Gartner reports – their hunger for laptop-related accessories has concur-



Laptop coolers are multi-taskers

rently risen. Take for example laptop stands and coolers.

A laptop stand or cooler primarily aims to solve your laptop's overheating issues, trying to keep its operating temperature down under full load. We reviewed one such laptop cooler, the Cooler Master Notepal U Stand (read the review here: <http://digit.in/JBNR5V>), and it brought down a laptop's temperature by up to 10 degree Celsius in various scenarios. These laptop coolers/stands also house a couple of more USB and other useful connectivity ports to add to your laptop's set of I/O ports. So yes, we deem laptop coolers – as long as they aren't insanely expensive – to be effective accessories to combat your laptop's overheating woes.

USB lights Not that effective

If you've ever made a big deal of the need to illuminate your laptop keyboard when using it in close to complete darkness, you probably forgot that in certain scenarios and acute screen angles, your laptop's keyboard is nearly always bathed in enough light to navigate the keys effectively. In such scenarios, the USB flex light you bought to illuminate your laptop's keyboard while travelling on a long-distance flight seems a bit pointless.

What's more, most of these inexpensive USB flex lights aren't powerful enough and don't come with controls to customise the intensity of their glow. Unless you've found other useful applications for its use, the USB light to illuminate your laptop's keyboard is a bit of a waste.

